

GNOMES: GEARBOUND & FEYBOUND

GNOMES: GEARBOUND & FEYBOUND IS A MONSTER SUPPLEMENT FOR 5E THAT PRESENTS GNOMES AS A DIVIDED CULTURAL lineage rather than a single whimsical archetype. Instead of treating gnomes as generic small inventors or forest illusionists, this book explores two fully realized doctrines: the Gearbound, who abandoned the deep woods in pursuit of industry and human progress, and the Feybound, who remained rooted in ancient pacts and slow-growing magic.

The intent of this product is mechanical clarity and encounter variety without CR inflation. Each ladder progresses from child and commoner through increasingly specialized battlefield roles, capping at CR 6 to remain settlement-scale threats rather than world-ending powers. These gnomes are intelligent, disciplined presences designed to influence encounters through positioning, preparation, and doctrine rather than brute escalation.

Cultural lore, motive, and political tension between the two paths are intentionally minimal. Whether this divergence was philosophical disagreement, gradual drift, or ancient fracture is left to the GM. Use these stat blocks as tools. Why gnomes chose steel or root is yours to decide.

THE GEARBOUND

The Gearbound Gnomes abandoned deep woodland life in pursuit of progress, structure, and innovation. Drawn to human cities and the promise of industry, they replaced living roots with forged frameworks and deliberate engineering. Their settlements are organized, their workshops disciplined, and their warfare prepared well in advance.

Gearbound encounters emphasize devices, constructs, battlefield positioning, and reaction-based defenses. They do not rely on wild magic or chaos. Instead, they solve problems with preparation, reinforced mechanisms, alchemical precision, and coordinated mechanical support. A Gearbound force feels methodical and engineered rather than impulsive.

THE FEYBOUND

The Feybound Gnomes remained within ancient groves and lingering fey crossings, preserving slow magic and generational pacts. Their power is patient, rooted, and often unsettling. Where the Gearbound build outward, the Feybound deepen inward.

Feybound encounters emphasize terrain control, layered charms, subtle enchantment, and gradual battlefield dominance. They reshape the ground beneath enemies, restrain through living growth, and influence combat through quiet inevitability rather than spectacle. A Feybound force feels ancient and deliberate, bending space and will without haste.

GEARBOUND GNOME ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Gearbound Gnome Child	0	Workshop-raised youth already curious about mechanisms and structured problem solving.
Gearbound Gnome Commoner	0	Practical urban citizen comfortable among tools, stone, and industry.
Gearbound Gnome Tool Runner	1/8	Agile courier who supports allies with rapid repositioning and logistical aid.
Gearbound Gnome Gearwright Apprentice	1/4	Junior engineer deploying simple snares and mechanical tricks.
Gearbound Gnome Tinker Adept	1/2	Battlefield device specialist using smoke, adhesive, and compact contraptions.
Gearbound Gnome Urban Mechanist	1	Disciplined engineer deploying small turrets and reactive defenses.
Gearbound Gnome Alchemical Engineer	2	Chemical tactician combining volatile mixtures with battlefield support.
Gearbound Gnome Clockwork Marshal	3	Construct commander coordinating mechanical allies with precision.
Gearbound Gnome Master Gearwright	4	Senior engineer enhancing and reinforcing allied constructs.
Gearbound Gnome High Technologist	6	Settlement-scale technological authority empowering devices and controlling mechanical forces.

FEYBOUND GNOME ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Feybound Gnome Child	0	Woodland youth subtly marked by lingering fey influence.
Feybound Gnome Grove Tender	0	Caretaker of sacred glades and quiet forest boundaries.
Feybound Gnome Mosskin	1/8	Stealthy woodland scout blending seamlessly with natural terrain.
Feybound Gnome Root Whisperer	1/4	Minor plant shaper restraining foes through grasping growth.
Feybound Gnome Glade Speaker	1/2	Early spellcaster weaving charms and simple battlefield magic.
Feybound Gnome Thorn Warden	1	Defensive warrior who punishes aggression with living briars.
Feybound Gnome Dreamcaller	2	Subtle enchanter influencing minds and momentum.
Feybound Gnome Briar Seer	3	Curse-weaving tactician shaping combat through control and foresight.
Feybound Gnome Circle Guardian	4	Circle defender creating sanctified terrain and layered protections.
Feybound Gnome Archglade Emissary	6	Powerful fey conduit reshaping large areas of battlefield terrain through verdant dominion.

GEARBOUND GNOMES

GEARBOUND GNOME CHILD

Small humanoid (gnome), any alignment

Armor Class 11

Hit Points 4 (1d6 + 1)

Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

Skills Investigation +2

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages Common, Gnomish

Challenge 0 (10 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Curious Mind. This gnome has advantage on Intelligence (Investigation) checks made to examine simple mechanical devices.

ACTIONS:

Improvised Tool. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +1 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 1 (1d4 - 1) bludgeoning damage.

REACTIONS:

Timid Retreat. When a creature this gnome can see moves within 5 ft. of it, this gnome can use its reaction to move up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

- The child avoids confrontation and flees when threatened.
- It uses Timid Retreat immediately when a creature approaches.
- It only attacks if cornered.
- It does not coordinate or act strategically.
- It prioritizes escape over combat.



GEARBOUND GNOME MASTER GEARWRIGHT

Small humanoid (gnome), any alignment

Armor Class 17 (half plate)

Hit Points 136 (16d6 + 80)

Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	20 (+5)	19 (+4)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws Int +6, Con +7

Skills Investigation +6, Perception +4

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages Common, Gnomish

Challenge 4 (1,100 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Master of Mechanisms. Constructs created or commanded by this gnome gain a +2 bonus to attack rolls.

Reinforced Design. This gnome has resistance to bludgeoning damage from nonmagical attacks.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack. This gnome makes two attacks with its mechanist's blade or repeating crossbow.

Mechanist's Blade. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) slashing damage.

Repeating Crossbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 40/160 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d10 + 2) piercing damage.

Deploy Heavy Turret (Recharge 5–6). As an action, this gnome deploys a Medium mechanical turret in an unoccupied space within 5 ft. The turret has AC 15, 30 hit points, and immediately makes one ranged attack (+6 to hit, range 60 ft., 10 (2d8 + 1) piercing damage). The turret lasts for 1 minute or until destroyed.

- The master gearwright deploys its heavy turret at the start of combat if available.
- It positions itself near its turret to maximize battlefield control.
- It focuses fire on the most dangerous enemy while the turret provides sustained ranged pressure.
- It uses Deploy Heavy Turret as soon as it recharges if the previous turret is destroyed.
- It does not engage in reckless melee unless forced, preferring controlled ranged combat supported by constructs.



FEYBOUND GNOME GLADE SPEAKER

Small humanoid (gnome), any alignment

Armor Class 14 (barkwoven leather)

Hit Points 45 (10d6 + 10)

Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Wis +5

Skills Nature +4, Perception +5

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages Common, Gnomish, Sylvan

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Fey Resilience. This gnome has advantage on saving throws against being charmed, and magic can't put this gnome to sleep.

Innate Spellcasting. This gnome's innate spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 13). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

- **At will:** *druidcraft*
- **1/day each:** *entangle*, *faerie fire*

ACTIONS:

Soothing Murmur (1/Day). This gnome speaks calming words to a creature within 30 ft. The target regains 9 (2d8) hit points.

Quarterstaff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) bludgeoning damage.

- The glade speaker opens combat with *faerie fire* or *entangle* if multiple enemies are present.
- It uses Soothing Murmur on the most injured ally.
- It avoids front-line combat and stays behind sturdier allies.
- It prioritizes battlefield control and support over direct damage.
- It retreats rather than fight to the death.



FEYBOUND GNOME ARCHGLADE EMISSARY

Small humanoid (gnome), any alignment

Armor Class 18 (enchanted barkplate)

Hit Points 168 (16d6 + 112)

Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	24 (+7)	18 (+4)	22 (+6)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Wis +9, Con +10, Cha +7

Skills Insight +9, Nature +7, Perception +9

Damage Resistances poison; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Condition Immunities charmed

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 19

Languages Common, Gnomish, Sylvan

Challenge 6 (2,300 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +3

Fey Sovereignty. Magic can't put this gnome to sleep, and this gnome is immune to being charmed.

Innate Spellcasting. This gnome's innate spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 17). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

- **At will:** *druidcraft*
- **3/day each:** *plant growth*, *hold person*
- **1/day each:** *greater invisibility*, *wall of thorns*

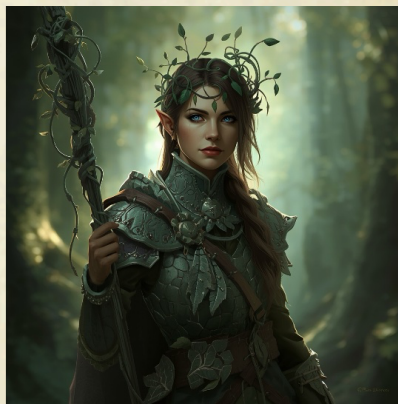
ACTIONS:

Verdant Dominion (Recharge 5–6). This gnome causes roots and briars to erupt in a 20-foot-radius area centered on a point it can see within 60 ft. The area becomes difficult terrain for hostile creatures for 1 minute. When a hostile creature starts its turn in the area, it must succeed on a DC 17 Strength saving throw or be restrained until the start of its next turn. The area remains lightly obscured by twisting foliage for the duration.

Multiattack. This gnome makes two attacks with its archglade staff.

Archglade Staff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (1d8 + 7) bludgeoning damage plus 7 (2d6) poison damage.

- The emissary opens with Verdant Dominion to control the battlefield.
- It casts *wall of thorns* to divide enemies or protect allies.
- It uses *greater invisibility* if pressured by ranged attackers.
- It targets the most dangerous foe with *hold person* before engaging in melee.
- It maintains a commanding presence, prioritizing control and protection of sacred territory.



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